

AFC Impact Measures

The five short checks AFC wrote to measure its impact

Version 1.1 · October 29, 2026

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About these measures

AFC measures its impact with five short checks it wrote itself, so every question can be shown to funders, partners, and town hall attendees. Impact Panel members answer them by email when they join, at 3 months, and at 12 months.

Check	Who answers	Statements	Score range
AFC Well-Being Check	Every panel member	5	5 to 25
Speaking Up Check	Advocate's Compass members	6	6 to 30
Goal Progress Check	Goal Getter members	6	6 to 30
Connection and Kindness Check	Care About You members	7	7 to 35
Craving Skills Check	Beat the Craving members	6	6 to 30

Each member answers the Well-Being Check plus the check for each app they use, along with a few other short questions. For someone who uses one app, a survey takes about 3 minutes.

How every check works

Every check uses the same instructions and the same five-point agree/disagree scale, so members learn it once.

Instructions shown above each check: *Thinking about the past month, how much do you agree or disagree with each statement?*

Answer	Points
Strongly disagree	1
Disagree	2
Neither agree nor disagree	3
Agree	4
Strongly agree	5

- **Total score.** Add the points. A higher score always means a better result.
- **Reverse scoring.** A statement marked *(reverse)* is scored the other way: Strongly agree is 1 point and Strongly disagree is 5.
- **Skipped statements.** Members can skip any statement. Score a check only when one statement or fewer is skipped, and fill that gap with the member's average on the other statements.
- **Format.** Ask each statement as its own multiple-choice question, not as a grid. Separate questions work better on phones and with screen readers.

AFC Well-Being Check

Every panel member answers these five statements, which give a shared picture of well-being across all four apps. Score: 5 to 25.

1. My life is heading in a direction I feel good about.
2. I make time for things I enjoy.
3. I feel supported by people in my life.
4. When stress builds up, I know what helps me feel better.
5. I have plans for the coming months that I'm excited about.

Speaking Up Check

Advocate's Compass members answer these six statements about preparing for meetings, speaking up, and following through. Score: 6 to 30.

1. Before an important meeting, I know what I want to get out of it.
2. I can explain what I need in my own words.
3. I ask questions when I don't understand something.
4. I speak up when a decision doesn't feel right for me.
5. I know where to find information about my rights.
6. I follow up when something I was promised doesn't happen.

Goal Progress Check

Goal Getter members answer these six statements about setting goals, taking steps, and believing they can reach them. Score: 6 to 30.

1. I know which goals matter most to me right now.
2. I break big goals into smaller steps.
3. I'm making steady progress on at least one goal.
4. When a plan stops working, I find another way forward.
5. I pay attention to more than one area of my life.
6. The goals I'm working on feel doable.

Connection and Kindness Check

Care About You members answer these seven statements about closeness, kindness given and received, and loneliness. Score: 7 to 35.

1. There is someone in my life I can be myself with.
2. I reach out to people I care about.
3. I've done something kind for someone else.
4. Someone has done something kind for me.
5. I take time to be kind to myself.
6. I feel like I belong somewhere.
7. Loneliness has been hard for me. *(reverse)*

Statement 7 is also reported on its own, because less loneliness is Care About You's core outcome.

Craving Skills Check

Beat the Craving members answer these six statements about coping skills, triggers, support, and confidence. The wording welcomes any recovery path. Score: 6 to 30.

1. When a craving hits, I know at least one thing I can do instead of using.
2. I can spot the people, places, or feelings that set off my cravings.
3. I have someone I can contact when a craving gets strong.
4. I believe a craving will pass if I ride it out.
5. I stick to my coping plan, even on hard days.
6. I feel confident I can stay on track with my recovery goals in the month ahead.

Other panel questions

Besides the checks, members answer a few short questions about how each app is working for them. These are AFC's own questions too.

Question	Answers	When
Which AFC apps do you use, and for how long?	For each app: Less than 2 weeks, 2 weeks to 3 months, More than 3 months	Joining
How helpful has [app] been for you so far?	1 Not at all helpful to 5 Very helpful	3 and 12 months
Could you do everything you wanted to in [app]?	Yes, Mostly, No	3 months
Since you started using [app], how has [area] changed?	Much worse, Worse, About the same, Better, Much better	3 and 12 months

Question	Answers	When
Goal Getter only: In the past year, did you reach a goal that matters to you?	Yes, Partly, Not yet	12 months
Anything else you'd like us to know?	Optional comment	Every survey

The [area] is "speaking up for yourself" for Advocate's Compass, "progress on goals that matter to you" for Goal Getter, "feeling connected to people in your life" for Care About You, and "handling cravings" for Beat the Craving.

Inside Advocate's Compass only. Each meeting's notes have an optional "How did it go?" section: "How prepared did you feel?" (1 Not at all to 5 Very prepared) and "Did you raise what mattered most to you?" (Yes, Partly, No). Nothing prompts for it, and it's counted only as totals.

Closing message. Every survey and snapshot ends: "Thank you. If you're struggling, call or text 988. In an emergency, call 911." Beat the Craving members also see SAMHSA's National Helpline, 1-800-662-4357.

Scoring and reporting

Results compare each member's own answers over time, and a change of about half a point per statement counts as real change.

Result	Well-Being, Speaking Up, Goal Progress, and Craving Skills	Connection and Kindness
Improved	Up 3 points or more	Up 4 points or more
Held steady	Changed by 2 points or fewer	Changed by 3 points or fewer
Declined	Down 3 points or more	Down 4 points or more

These cutoffs are AFC's starting rules, and the Board reviews them after the first year of results.

- **Less loneliness (Care About You's core outcome).** A member starts out lonely if they Agree or Strongly agree with statement 7 when they join. They're less lonely if their answer moves at least one step toward Disagree by their latest survey.
- **Confidence (Beat the Craving).** The share of members who Agree or Strongly agree with statement 6 of the Craving Skills Check.
- **Totals only.** Reports never show anyone's own answers, and any group under 10 people shows as "fewer than 10," including results for a single county.
- **Honest labels.** Results are called self-reported AFC measures, and AFC says its apps "contributed to" a change, not "caused" it.

Well-being snapshot (template)

> **Your well-being snapshot.** Your well-being score today is [score] out of 25. When you joined, it was [score], so it's [up or down] [number] points.
>
> This score comes from the AFC Well-Being Check, five short statements we wrote to see how members are doing. Your score is just for you, and it isn't a diagnosis.
>
> Thank you. If you're struggling, call or text 988. In an emergency, call 911.

Development record

AFC wrote each statement from what its app is meant to change, and this record shows funders and a future evaluator how the checks were built and tested.

How the checks were written

- **Start from the outcome.** Each check began with the app's core outcome in the logic models, then asked what a person would notice in their own life if that outcome happened.
- **AFC's own words.** No statement was adapted from a published scale. Each one was then compared word for word with published scales on the same topics, and any that came too close was rewritten.
- **Plain language.** One idea per statement, everyday words, and 6 to 16 words each, about 10 on average. The statements read at about a 3rd- to 4th-grade level (Flesch-Kincaid estimate).
- **Positive wording.** Agreeing means doing better, except for one reverse statement about loneliness, which names the problem Care About You exists to ease.

Testing plan, before each app's panel opens

- ☐ Read-aloud test: 3 to 5 people from the app's target group explain what each statement means to them, and any statement that confuses two or more people gets rewritten
- ☐ Accessibility review: disabled testers answer the survey with screen readers and other tools during each app's pre-launch review
- ☐ Partner review: a recovery partner organization reviews the Craving Skills Check wording, and a disability advocacy partner reviews the Speaking Up Check
- ☐ Consistency check: once 50 or more members have answered a check, test whether its statements hang together (Cronbach's alpha of .70 or higher), and rewrite any statement that doesn't fit
- ☐ Board review: share test results and any changes at the next Board meeting, and log them below

Changing a check

Changing a statement after an app's panel opens breaks before-and-after comparisons. Changes wait for the yearly October plan review, start a new version, and are reported separately from earlier results.

Version history

Date	Version	Change	Decided by
October 29, 2026	1.1	Six statements rewritten after a word-by-word check found them too close to published scales: Well-Being 1, 2, 4, and 5; Goal Progress 6; and Connection and Kindness 1. Well-Being 2 now asks about enjoyment instead of energy.	Sam
October 28, 2026	1.0	Five AFC checks replace the published scales in earlier plans; agree/disagree answers; kindness received added to the Connection and Kindness Check	Sam

Sharing these measures

Apps for Change owns these checks, so the full text can go in funder reports, partner packets, town hall slides, the website, and the annual impact report.

- **Credit line.** Every copy carries: "© 2026 Apps for Change. AFC Impact Measures, version 1.1."
- **Questions, never answers.** Share the questions anywhere. Share members' results only as totals, under the rules above.
- **One current version.** Use the version in this document everywhere, and update the version number when a statement changes.
- **Requests from others.** If another organization asks to use the checks, the Board decides how. One option is an open license that lets others reuse them with credit.